



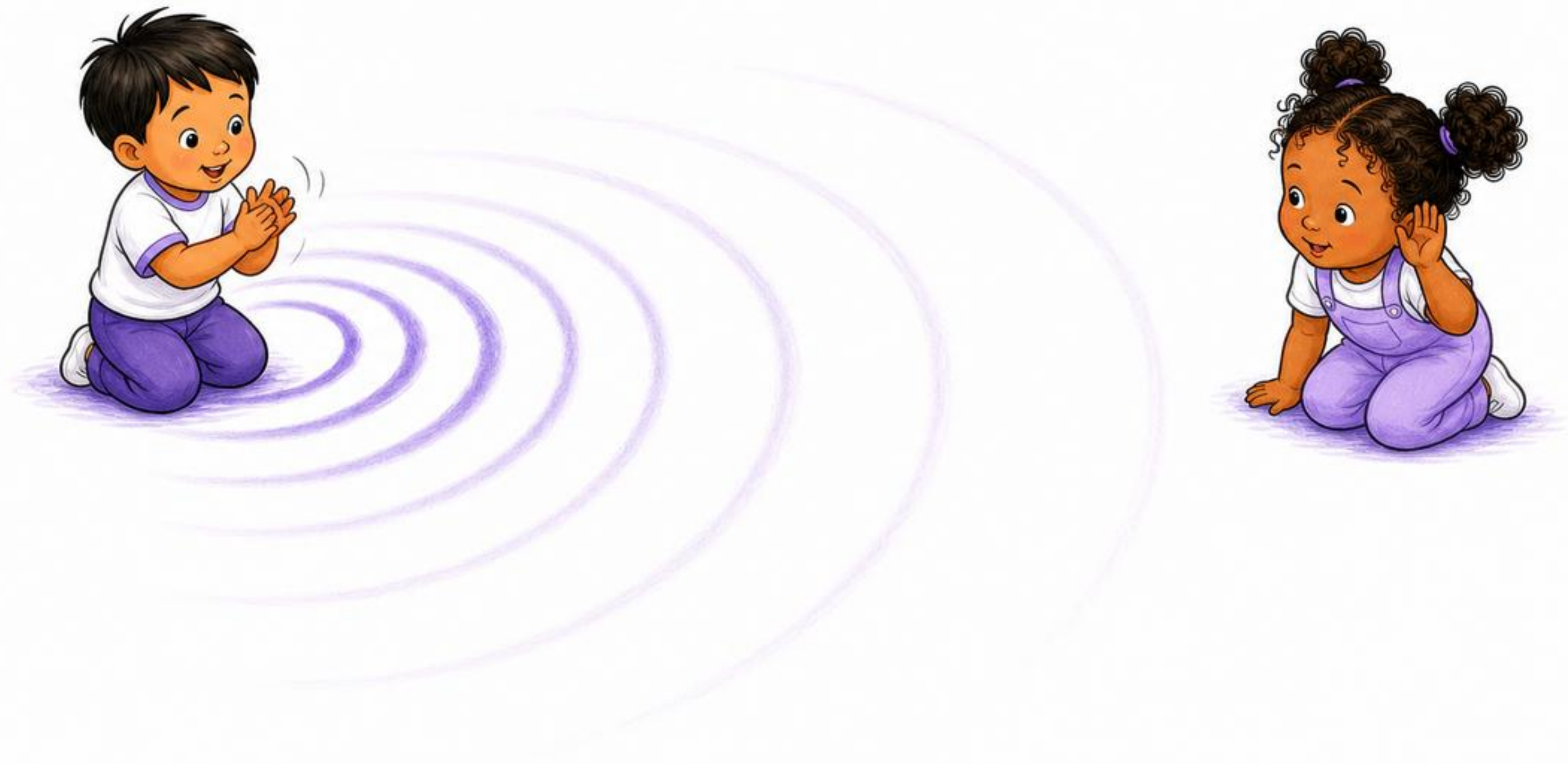
The Message That Traveled



Electra heard the clock.
Tick came before.
Tock came after.



Poz clapped across the yard.
Electra saw Poz's hands.
Then Electra heard the clap.



"The clap was real,"
Electra said,
"but it was not everywhere at once."



Poz stood by the tree.
The clap began there.



Electra dropped a pebble.
Rings ran away from the splash.



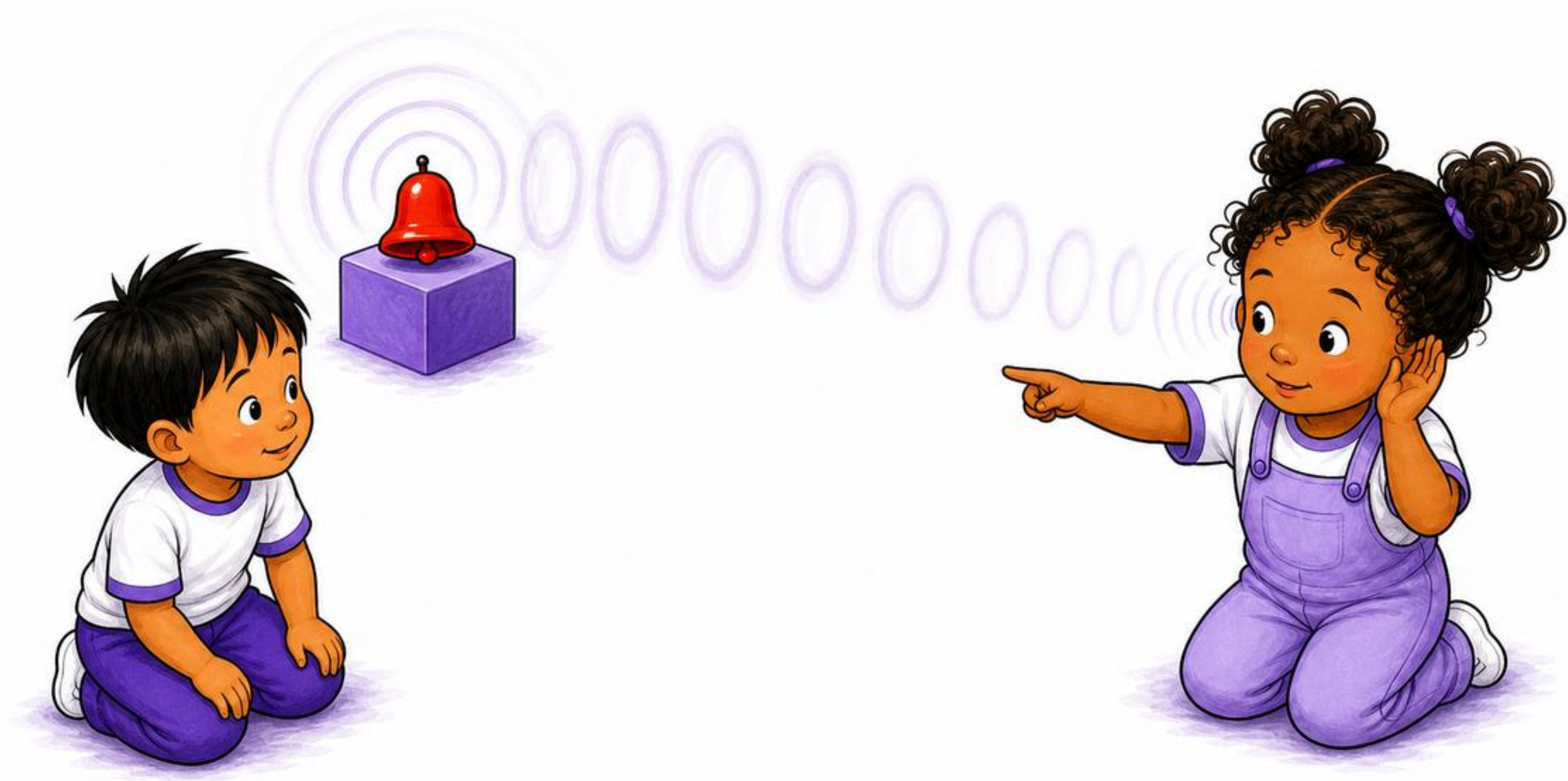
A leaf floated on the water.
The ring reached it.
The leaf moved.



Poz tapped the near bell.
Electra heard it quickly.



Poz tapped the far bell.
Electra listened.
Then it rang.



Electra pointed from bell to ear.
"The message came across here."



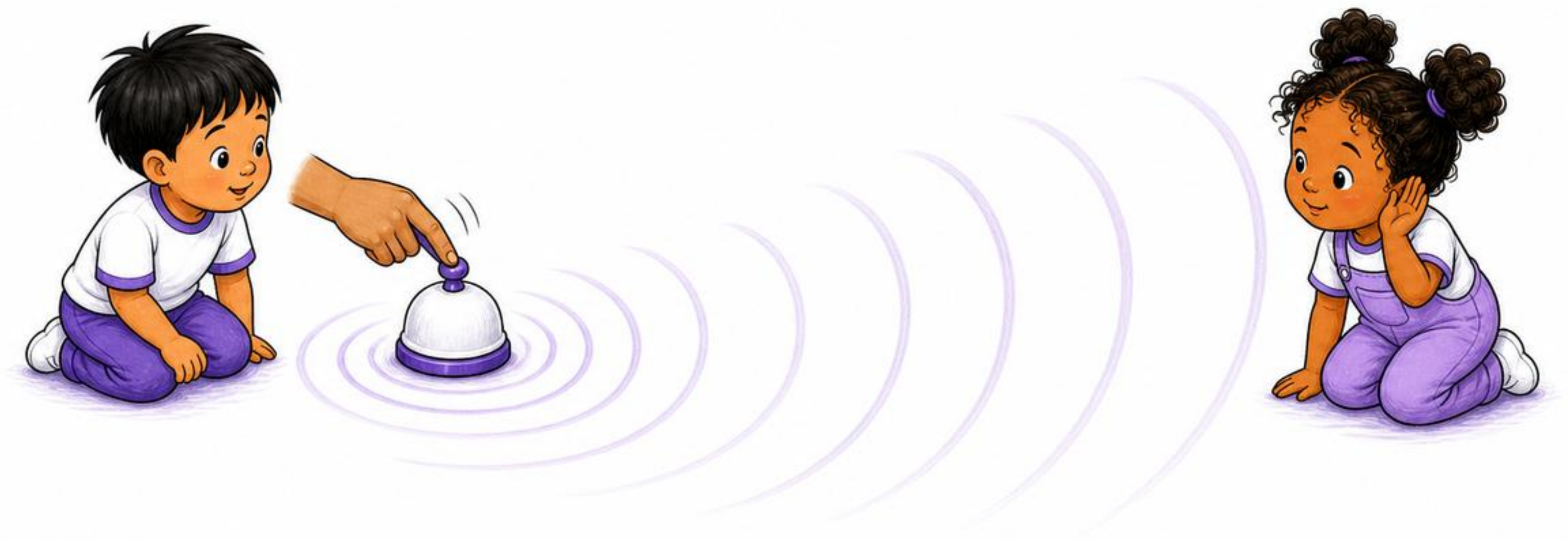
Poz pushed a toy boat.
A little wake opened behind it.
The wake touched a paper leaf.
The leaf slid away.



Clap.
Ring.
Ripple.
Roll.
Each one traveled.



"A message can be on the way,"
Electra said,
"before it reaches me."



Begin.
Travel.
Arrive.



Begin.
Travel.
Arrive.